Magic Constants

PHP also provides a number of "magic constants," so-called because their values are determined when your code is evaluated, rather than when it is first compiled. All magic constants follow the naming convention of being wrapped in double underscores. They are as follows:

- `__LINE__` – line number of current file
- `__FILE__` – full path and filename of current file
- `__DIR__` – directory of current file
- `__FUNCTION__` – function name (will be empty if used outside a function)
- `__CLASS__` – will have a value if your code resides in a class method
- `__TRAIT__` – similar to __class__
- `__METHOD__` – another OOP feature, to be covered soon
- `__NAMESPACE__` – yet another OOP feature
- `ClassName::class` – and yet another OOP feature

As you can see, these magic constants follow a naming convention, and for this reason you should avoid declaring your own constants with double underscores. There's always the risk that one day your `__CONSTANT__` is inadvertently added to the PHP magic constant list…

Superglobals

Similar to magic and predefined constants, there are some built-in globally available data structures called *superglobals* that you can make good use of throughout your code. These are not constants, and it is possible to modify them at runtime, though that is generally a Very Bad Idea. (Other code, not necessarily your own, may well be relying on this data. Better to copy the values somewhere and work with the copies instead.)